

TUGRUL GUNER

AI Engineering Leader | Portfolio Strategy | Hands-on Architecture

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PROFILE

AI engineering leader with an MBA, a Ph.D., more than five years of AI and MLOps experience, and a decade of Python expertise. I directly manage four people, provide technical and cross-functional leadership across two pods, and oversee seven projects. I combine portfolio-level strategy and stakeholder leadership with hands-on work in architecture, prototypes, shared platforms, and production delivery.

EXPERIENCE

AI Engineering Manager | CDAI

Toronto, ON | Jan 2026 - Present

- Directly manage four people and provide cross-functional and technical leadership across two pods of five and seven people.
- Oversee seven projects across the portfolio, aligning priorities, dependencies, architecture, stakeholders, and delivery.
- Increased team delivery velocity by 2.5x and launched three products, including a recommendation system that improved menu-item attachment rate by 4x.
- Remain hands-on: prototype ideas, make architectural changes, deliver production work, and build shared platforms that reduce redundancy and improve scalability.
- Started the company's AI & Science channel and continuously share developments across both fields; co-host the company-wide AI Center of Excellence meeting with the enterprise architect.
- Lead stakeholders at every level and build high-performing teams around ownership, strong engineering standards, and fast delivery.

Technical Manager, AI Architect | Haptiq

Toronto, ON | May 2025 - Jan 2026

- Built Haptiq's AI team and first AI infrastructure, establishing the roadmap, modular architecture, and engineering practices from the ground up.
- Recruited and led a seven-person team across ML engineering, MLOps, and backend development; created a culture of ownership, knowledge-sharing, and high performance.
- Led technical delivery and client conversations for the company's first AI product, helping sell AI solutions to companies and contributing to more than \$2M in new revenue.
- Worked directly with clients and executives to turn business needs into product direction, architecture, delivery plans, risk assessments, and performance reporting.
- Standardized reviews, documentation, release management, sprint planning, and ownership to turn a new team into a reliable delivery system.

Lead MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Dec 2024 - May 2025

- Architected scalable AI and backend systems aligned with business goals and integrated Ray with Kubernetes.
- Led cross-functional delivery, mentoring, cost optimization, availability, and fault-tolerance work.

Senior MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Sep 2022 - Dec 2024

- Automated backend systems for model integration and scaling, and built user-friendly APIs for rapid experimentation and deployment.
- Reduced Kubernetes infrastructure costs by 60% with KServe and improved model performance 10x with quantization and ONNX.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and Databricks to streamline the machine-learning lifecycle.

TECHNICAL RANGE

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash, Git | **ML:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, DSPy, vLLM

Agents: Pydantic AI, LangGraph, CrewAI, LlamaIndex, FastMCP | **MLOps:** KServe, MLflow, Ray Serve, LitServe

Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Databricks, GitHub Actions | **Systems:** FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, Qdrant, MongoDB, Redis, RabbitMQ

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

Postdoctoral Fellow, University of Ottawa, 2021–2022 — deep learning for quantum optics and beam shaping

Postdoctoral Fellow, Institut national de la recherche scientifique (INRS), 2018–2021 — ultrafast transmission electron microscopy and measurement algorithms

MBA, Quantic School of Business and Technology, 2025 | **Ph.D., Materials Science and Engineering**, Izmir Institute of Technology, 2018
30 journal publications, one patent, 1,023 Google Scholar citations, h-index 19, i10-index 21 (September 2026).

OPEN SOURCE & WRITING

Created **ModePot**, an open-source family focused on simpler APIs, modern runtimes, performance, and bounded agent-owned decisions. Write **Passionately Curious** and publish personal and technology essays on Medium.